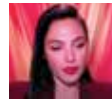




WB Pictures - HBO Max
Warner Bros. Pictures to release entire 2021 slate on HBO Max and theatres.
<http://digit.in/jan21-33>



Wonder Woman 3
Wonder Woman 3 is currently in the works with director Patty Jenkins; will have traditional theatrical release. <http://digit.in/jan21-34>

Information age problems

From cringe binge watching to revenge shopping, we are only beginning to realise the issues that need to be tackled

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TRUTH DECAY

The term comes from a book published in 2018, called *Truth Decay: An Initial Exploration of the Diminishing Role of Facts and Analysis in American Public Life* written by Jennifer Kavanagh and Michael D Rich. The term is used to describe the reduced relevance of facts and data in the public life of Americans, and is characterised by four trends. These trends, according to the authors are an increasing disagreement on what facts are and how data should be interpreted, a blurring of lines between what constitutes as fact and opinion, the increasing influence of personal beliefs over what is considered fact, and a declining trust in respected sources of facts. The researchers have identified the factors causing truth decay to include an education system that cannot meet the requirements of the population, increasing political and social polarisation, and changes in the information environment, including the emergence of various social media

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platforms. The authors maintain a distinction between truth decay and the concepts of both fake news and a post fact world. As the reliance on data and facts has only increased in all other fields except politics and civil discourse, the authors argue that we do not live in a post fact world at all. Additionally, fake news does not really capture the way in which information is processed, instead of how it is packaged and delivered. Even if fake news were to be magically stopped overnight, the underlying forces that are driving truth decay will continue to work. What we found interesting to contemplate was the similarities and differences between truth decay and the concept of doublespeak from 1984.



PRE BUNK

Researchers at Cambridge university seem to keep coming up with interesting experiments *cough... analytics... cough* on social media, and one of the latest ones is a game that attempts to pre-bunk the spread of misinformation related to the pandemic, before it goes viral. The game uses a simulated environment to show players the genesis of misinformation, and how it can spread rapidly. The researchers could demonstrate that playing the game made the players better at spotting fake news. Meanwhile Twitter had to deploy additional machinery to contain the rapid spread of misinformation during the US elections, and had started putting up messages